



Learning from setbacks: Ravindra feels every loss is an opportunity to learn and improve as a player.

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thing. So there are a million things that go through your head, little decisions you feel could have made a difference. Maybe they do, maybe they don't. Obviously, it's hurtful to have it two years in a row, and we were a lot closer in the Champions Trophy final.

Both games were extremely disappointing. But again, that's cricket. There's always going to be a winner and a loser. And India is a very, very good team, especially in those conditions in Dubai and at home. It is a quality unit that has played so much cricket there.

There are always learnings about yourself, about batting and bowling, and also about clarity and decision-making under pressure. As a team, I'm sure we've had a bit of time off, and we'll come together later as a T20 group, especially later in the year, to discuss that.

The crazy thing about cricket is that it always moves on. I think that's always going to be in the back of your head.

But there's always the next

challenge, and that's great. It means you can't really dwell on what has happened.

On dealing with pressure, setbacks and perspective

I've got some great mentors around me, and I lean on them, especially in that New Zealand setup. I've played under some brilliant captains. I've got Kane Williamson there, Mitchell Santner, all these guys to bounce ideas off.

I speak to Kane a lot, read, and do a little bit of self-discovery. Then it's about being patient. It might seem like a small career and only a short period of time in our lives, but for me, it's calmness and patience that matter. I genuinely believe everything happens for a reason. If you don't believe that, it's hard to stay sane.

As a player, you also need to accept that failure is part of the game. And it depends on how you define failure, right? Is it just not scoring runs? It's probably not that. We all want to score runs. I think Rahul Dravid said this a while ago: "You're going to fail more than you succeed, especially as a batter..."

So you've got to come to terms with that. But again, not scoring runs isn't failure. The failure is not

Switching between formats: Over the last two years, Ravindra has been a constant presence for the Kiwis across the three formats. K. BHAGYA PRAKASH

consistently trying to improve yourself. If you get too caught up in that, it starts to stack up, and you're trying to prove to others who you are.

But that's not really me. I'm just here. I love the game, and I love trying to get better each time. That's what I measure everything by. The other stuff, the noise, doesn't really matter because you're not here just for personal accolades. Of course, you want to do as well as you can, but as soon as you lean too much towards that, you're in trouble.

If I look back at the Champions Trophy game against Bangladesh last year, I was very lucky to walk away with just a small scar leading up to that match during the tri-series in Pakistan. I was lucky. An inch lower and my career might have been over, I could have lost my eye. These things give you perspective.

Perspective is probably the biggest thing in our game, realising we get to do what we love for a living. So much has to happen for us to reach this stage.